

Question 32 · Unit 2 · 8 Marks

State any two purposes of feedback in HRD practices.

Introduction

Feedback is purposeful information, not scolding. Two core purposes: improve present performance, and support learning/development. Then add other purposes.

Detailed points

1. **Purpose 1 — Improve current performance.** Let people know where they stand against expectations so they can correct behaviour and results quickly. Without this, errors repeat.
2. **Example.** A chef told ‘salt is high in today’s gravy’ can correct tonight. A yearly remark ‘food average’ cannot.
3. **Purpose 2 — Support learning and development.** Reinforce what is going well; guide training, coaching and career choices. Feedback is how people learn from work itself — informal HRD.
4. **Motivation purpose.** Recognition through positive feedback meets higher-order needs and builds confidence.
5. **Role clarification.** Feedback reveals misunderstood expectations — a purpose linked to dyad development.
6. **Climate purpose.** Open respectful feedback signals trust and openness; it builds HRD climate.
7. **System improvement.** Upward feedback helps the organisation fix processes, tools and policies, not only people.
8. **Training evaluation.** Feedback after programmes (reaction, behaviour) improves HRD design — another purpose.

Conclusion. Two purposes: corrective (performance) and developmental (learning). Mention motivation, climate, and system improvement to complete 8 marks.